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Travel Radio Australia. We are at the Australian and New Zealand Disaster Management Conference on the Gold Coast in Queensland. And I've run into Dean Iverson from Total Defence Fire Retardant Systems.

And Dean, welcome to the program. Thank you so much. And thanks for taking the time to talk to me.

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Fire is a huge problem, bushfires in Australia. And we all know that, both fire and flood. Tell us about Total Defence.

It's a fantastic program for people and organizations to use. Yeah, absolutely. Yeah, Total Defence is a new technology that's come out.

We've brought it into Australia. And what we did was, we thought we'd take a different approach on the certification of Total Defence. And we dealt with ALS, who did some of the toxicity tests for us.

We also did the aquatic tests for saltwater and freshwater, which we passed those certifications. So we're really excited about having the product. And it's something different.

It's new technology in the fact that it attacks the heat. So it's rapid cooling technology is what we've incorporated into our product. What we find is that it's really great for the environment.

It's something different for each of the countries that we're working with, and in particular Australia, is there's a lot of plant species and stuff that need to be protected. The product is PFOS and fluorine free. So we don't have any of those nasties in the products.

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People like councils and government organizations can use your product to maybe not only put out fires, but create defence systems, I suppose. Yes, you can apply it beforehand. The great thing about the product is its diversification.

You can use it in sprinkler systems in apartment buildings. You can use it for putting out EV fires, bush fires. You can actually have it set up to homeowners to actually have the product in order to combat fires within their property or adjacent to their property.

I mean, I don't recommend them going out and fighting a major bush fire because the local fire departments will be there for that. But if they have something that's happening on their fire and

they want to actually... And then there's also the added product where we have it set up in a sort of like, it's like a hairspray bottle. It's double walled and it's pressurized with air.

So it has a product in there. So it doesn't have nitrogen in it to sort of pressurize it. It's actually air, which just makes it safe.

If people want that in their home for maybe on standby, if they have a kitchen fire or something, they can really use that. Yeah, absolutely. I mean, we're still going through that certification project process with the Australian regulations and stuff.

But that is something that we're hoping to have put through in very short order. Yeah. And with the governments and the big firefighting groups like the SES and all that sort of thing, I suppose they can lay down your product as fire breaks other than burning down environment.

Yeah. Yeah. You can do it as a pre-treatment as well.

So, I mean, you can either use it directly on flame. That's where it's really effective is directly on flame. And then what the great thing about it is it prevents the reignition.

So if you've put enough product down that it doesn't... So it foams up, which is great, but it attacks the heat, which is the key element. So it'll actually stop it from reigniting. It interrupts the free radicals, for those people to know, so it doesn't allow it to reignite.

So that's what's great. Now, Dean Iverson from Total Defence Fire Retardant Systems. What's your background? How did you get involved in this and give us your impressions of Australia as well? Yeah, well, coming from Canada, we also have the same challenges as you guys have.

My background is I've been 35 years in bushfire or wildfire expertise back in Canada. And then I started to find... I started looking at Australia as an opportunity of a place where we work on opposite seasons. So I was doing six months in Canada with my bushfire crews.

And then I came here and I started up operations here. And we have like a forestry and firefighting response crews here. And then, so I was going back and forth, but now I'm here full time.

And then I got involved with this product probably over 10 years ago, and it's a patent product. And I just really wanted to make a difference in the world. And this is one of the biggest ways that you can do that.

So in Australia, of course, we have guaranteed floods, guaranteed fires. We know it's going to happen. So people really must be prepared.

And the reaction you're getting from the government departments and the emergency services must be great. Well, it is, right? They're embracing something that's just the newer technology,

how it focuses on rapid cooling technology. And so I think that that's what makes a difference.

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That's what really stands out. And it's versatility, right? So it can be used in different applications, not just focus on bushfire. It can be used in other sort of applications to deal with fires or structural fires.

And we're here at the ANZ DMC, that's Australia New Zealand Disaster Management Conference. Give us your impressions of this particular get together. It looks pretty good.

This is amazing. I love the people that have come by. Everybody's really interested.

(4:51 - 5:18)

Been seeing the other vendors that are here, they're coming over and everybody's introducing themselves. It's such a welcoming environment. So I'm really grateful that we chose this venue to participate in.

And how can people find out more about Total Defence online? Yeah, they can go to www.totaldefence.au and go onto the website and then they can get my contact details and we'll go from there. Dean Iverson, thank you so much for being part of the program. And thank you.

Thank you for your time.